

SAMUEL K. HUGHES

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Research Areas

Primary: Real Estate Finance; Secondary: Commercial Real Estate, Household Finance, Urban Economics.

Research & Professional Experience

2023-Present	Researcher, Office of Financial Research U.S. Department of the Treasury, Washington, D.C.
2015-2017	Research Data Analyst, Prof. Christopher Palmer Fisher Center for Real Estate and Urban Economics, UC Berkeley-Haas, Berkeley, CA
2013-2015	Analyst Analysis Group, Washington, D.C.
2013	Research Assistant (for Executive Director Janneke Ratcliffe) UNC Center for Community Capital, Chapel Hill, NC
2012	Economic Policy Intern, Housing Finance Group (for Director Julia Gordon) Center for American Progress, Washington, D.C.

Education

2017-2023	Ph.D. in Applied Economics, The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania <i>Thesis committee: Benjamin Keys (chair), Joe Gyourko, Todd Sinai, Jessie Handbury</i>
2009-2013	B.A. in Economics & Political Science, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill (UNC-CH)

Working Papers

- “Debt Rollover Risk and Real Effects in Rental Housing” (available upon request)
- “No News is Bad News: Monitoring, Risk, and Stale Financial Performance in Commercial Real Estate” with Joseph Nichols (available upon request)
- “Housing Demand & Affordability for Low-Wage Households: Evidence from Minimum Wage Changes”

Work in Progress

- “Segmentation and Returns on Rental Housing” with Benjamin Keys & Jessie Handbury (available upon request)
- “Cash-Flow Responsiveness of Landlords: Evidence from Shifts in Mortgage Payments”
- OFR Brief: “Crypto Exposure and Household Financial Conditions” with Francisco Ilabaca, Jacob Lockwood, and Kevin Zhao (forthcoming)
- “Pricing Credit Risk & Identifying Distress in Office Real Estate”
- “Insuring Labor Market Risk for Renters Affects Financial Risk for Landlords, Investors, and Lenders”

Teaching Experience

Spring 2021 & 2022	Teaching Assistant, Prof. Joe Gyourko; Housing Markets (REAL/BEPP 208/708), MBA/Undergraduate
Fall 2018, 2019, & 2020	Teaching Assistant, Prof. Ioana Marinescu; Economics for Social Policy (MSSP 668), MS/MA
Spring 2020	Head Teaching Assistant, Profs. Mike Abito & Uli Doraszelski; Managerial Economics (BEPP 250), Undergraduate

Fellowships and Awards

2018	Finalist, Penn Prize for Excellence in Teaching by Graduate Students, UPenn
2009-2013	Honors Program & Merit Scholarship Recipient, UNC-CH
2012-2013	Phi Beta Kappa & Omicron Delta Epsilon, UNC-CH

Seminar & Conference Participation

2025	[anticipated] ASSA (AREUEA)
2024	AREUEA National Conference; Mortgage Market Research Conference (Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia); Office of Financial Research; Federal Reserve Board Stress Testing Seminar
2023	UNC Kenan-Flagler Finance; Federal Housing Finance Agency; Office of Financial Research; Federal Trade Commission; Consumer Financial Protection Bureau; Federal Reserve Board Real Estate Finance Seminar; Wharton Real Estate & Urban Economics Seminar
2021	Wharton Real Estate & Urban Economics Seminar; Southern Economics Association Conference
2020	Wharton Real Estate & Urban Economics Seminar; APPAM DC Student Conference; Virtual AREUEA Summer Conference; Session Moderator at UPenn Young Economists Symposium

Professional Activities

Referee for:

1. Review of Economics and Statistics; Southern Economic Journal

Department Service:

1. Peer Mentor, Office of Financial Research.
2. Peer Mentor, Wharton Doctoral Council Mentoring Program (2020-2021).
3. Co-Organizer, Energy Economics and Finance Seminar, Kleinman Center for Energy Policy (2018-2019).